

ALVIN'S GUIDE

Master Confluence the Fast Way

FIRST EDITION

By Alvin the PM

Creator of AlvinthePM.com

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Thank You!

Thanks for downloading my FREE Guide to master how to use Confluence software the fast way!

Know someone who would find this useful? They can grab their own copy right here:

<https://www.alvinthepm.com/tutorialguide>

-> **Sign-up to Confluence Software for FREE here:** [Click Here](#)

For more helpful resources like this:

➔ Subscribe to my YouTube Channel, **Alvin the PM:** [Click here](#)

Also, I'd love to hear from you. If you found this super helpful, please let me know and [drop me a comment here](#).

Good luck, Alvin

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Alvin's Guide: Master Confluence Software the Fast Way

Getting Started with Confluence Software

Step 1 – [Click here to create a FREE account with the Confluence software.](#)

Step 2 – Follow along with my step-by-step FREE course to master the Confluence software.



The image shows a banner for a 'Confluence COMPLETE COURSE!'. On the left, there's a list of topics including 'All content', 'Blog', 'Automation', 'Calendar', 'Dashboards', 'Diagrams', 'Forms', 'Gantt charts', 'Maps', 'Portals', 'Reports', 'Templates', 'Webhooks', 'Workflows', 'Dashboards', 'Forms', 'Gantt charts', 'Maps', 'Portals', 'Reports', 'Templates', 'Webhooks', 'Workflows'. A large yellow arrow points from the 'Dashboards' section to the right. On the right, there's a screenshot of the 'Issue Log' table.

ID No	Issue Description	Identified By	Owner	Op...
1	Great! Everything shows but after connect string	Roger	Roger	Mar 15
2	User Login displays incorrect button	Roger	Roger	
3	Datatable does not correctly add the numbers.	Roger	Roger	
4	The incorrect record filter when the user click add			

MASTER how to use Confluence for beginners **step-by-step**, by watching my **FREE Course** by [clicking this link here.](#)

➔ [Click here to watch my FREE course on mastering how to use Confluence.](#)

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Confluence Keyboard Shortcuts I Use the Most

Keyboard Shortcut	What this does
G, followed by d	Opens up home page
G, followed by R	Opens up recent dropdown menu at top
C	Creates a blank Page in Confluence
/	Opens up search bar at top right to search for different pages
[	Collapse and expand left panel
E	Go into "editing" mode and edit a page you're working on
r	Opens up Presenter mode on a Published page
F	Stars a page, so it's added as a 'Bookmark' under the Starred menu
When you're in EDITING mode on a Page:	
/	Insert a macro when editing a Page
//	Add an appropriate date from a Calendar when editing a page
Alt K Cmmd K	Opens up Link window, to link to another document in Confluence or JIRA, or outside website
:	Add an emoji
Shift Alt T (Shift + Opt +T)	Inserts Table
/[or /] Or, Type [] followed by space bar	Adds Task List Macro

What is Confluence?

- Online software collaboration tool that allows you to create, edit, and share documents with your team, in real-time
- Often seen as a "preferred" software for you to know on job postings, if you're looking into Technical Engineering, Scrum Master, or Project Manager Roles
- Think of Confluence as the Wikipedia or the "digital brain" for your organization, where it stores meeting minutes, notes, and any knowledge tied to your organization's projects.

How Confluence Works

- Think of Confluence as a binder that contains different folders specific to your organization's projects and teams.
 - Inside each folder contains the content and documentation your team is working on, related to your project
- Confluence is broken up at the top-level with "**Spaces**"
 - A "**Space**" is kind of like the folders you use to store information specific to a subject
 - Underneath each "Space", you have "**Pages**"
 - Each "**Page**" is physically where you contain the content & documentation for your team
 - Examples of Pages
 - 1 on 1 Notes
 - Meeting Minutes
 - Status Report
 - Discussion Notes
 - Project Gantt Charts / Roadmaps
 - Requirements Documentation
 - When you're editing each "Page", you can use "Macros" to customize how information is displayed
 - When you're in Edit mode of a Page, type the forward slash key, /
 - Examples of Macros you can use
 - Action Items, Emojis, Tables, Status, Information Panels, Dates, etc

Using Your Personal Space

Your Personal Space is an area where you can capture your own notes and make it specific to you.

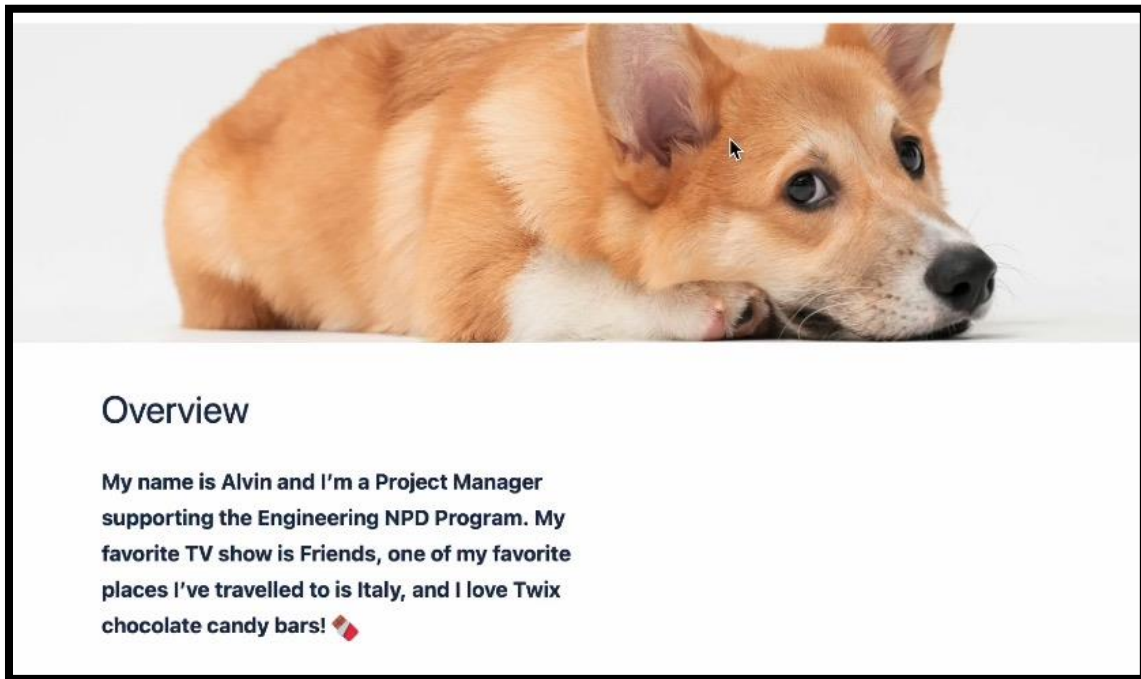
Alvin's Tip: Add a fun intro about who you are, your role, and fun facts about you.

For example: "My name is Alvin and I'm a Project Manager supporting the Engineering NPD Program. My favorite TV show is Friends, one of my favorite places I've traveled to is Italy, and I love Twix chocolate candy bars!"

- Feel free to customize it even more by adding in emojis.
- Type forward slash key '/' to open up the Macros menu and choose emojis you'd like to use.
- Customize your Header Page by inserting an image.

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Alvin's Example of Customizing Your Personal Space:



Other important sections in the left panel:

1. Blogs - Create blog posts sorted by Date
2. Space Settings - Customize your settings for how you view and access your Space in Confluence
3. Shortcuts - Add website shortcuts that you visit frequently
 - a. To add a shortcut, click on the + Icon, and add in the website you want as a shortcut.
4. Content - This is where you store ALL your pages.

Alvin's Tip: I like to create pages specific to my 1on1 Notes with my Manager, and a personal overview of the Projects I'm leading.

Creating a 1-on-1 Notes with Your Manager Page

- To add a Page, click on the + Icon next to the CONTENT Section Header in the left panel.
- Name the title of your page - '1on1, 4/21/24' (or something similar, with the date of your choice)
- Use the following macros to create different Header sections: *Note Panel*, *Info Panel*, and *Custom Panel*.
- To make creating your Header sections faster, you can always left-click and select the previous Headers you've made, and copy & paste it. Then, edit it to suit your needs.

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Here's an example of what your 1on1 Notes with your Manager could look like:

CAREER GROWTH		
GOAL		UPDATE
By Q2 this year, sit in a few calls to learn more about NPD projects I can support		4/21 - Scheduled time with NPD Manager
By Q4 this year, lead a presentation with the team		4/21 - Brainstorming topics
SELF DEVELOPMENT		
GOAL		UPDATE
By Q3, manage a summer intern, and gain more experience managing direct reports.		4/21/24 - Manager looking into budget
By Q4 this year, attend training and become Certified as a PMI-Agile Certified Practitioner.		4/21/24 - Purchased course.
PROJECT STATUS & ROADBLOCKS		
PROJECT	STATUS	ROADBLOCKS/COMMENTS
Project A	Off Track	2 week delay with receiving parts
Project B	On Track	No issues
Project C	At Risk	Testing not meeting acceptance criteria, will need to repeat validation
PERSONAL TOPICS		
Taking one week off in June		
NEXT STEPS		
Follow-up with NPD Manager		

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Alvin's Example of 1-on-1 Notes with Manager in Confluence:

CAREER GROWTH

GOAL	UPDATE
By Q2 this year, sit in a few calls to learn more about NPD projects I can support.	4/21/24 - Scheduled time with NPD Manager
By Q4 this year, lead a presentation with the team.	4/21/24 - Brainstorming topics

SELF DEVELOPMENT

GOAL	UPDATE
By Q3, manage a summer intern, and gain more experience managing direct reports.	4/21/24 - Manager looking into budget
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PROJECT STATUS & ROADBLOCKS

PROJECT	STATUS	ROADBLOCKS / COMMENTS
Project A	OFF TRACK	2 week delay with receiving parts
Project B	ON TRACK	On track, no issues.
Project C	AT RISK	Testing not meeting acceptance criteria, will need to repeat validation.

PERSONAL TOPICS

- Taking one week off in June

NEXT STEPS

- Follow-up with NPD Manager

Creating a Personal Page - Your Project Overview

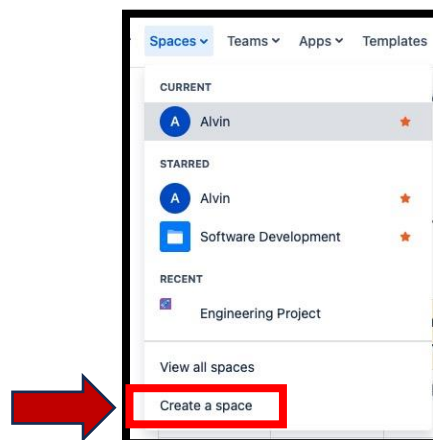
- To add a Page to your Space, on the left hand side, click on the PLUS SIGN.
Title your page, "Project Overview" or something similar.
- Add a table by using the table macro (/table), and edit it so it has a total of 6 columns, for the following:
 - Project Name
 - Start Date
 - Planned Finish
 - Budget
 - Team Size
 - Accomplishments

Your final Project Overview Table will look like this, in Confluence:

Project Overview					
Owned by Alvin ... a minute ago • 1 min read • See how many people viewed this page					
Project	Start Date	Planned Finish	Budget	Team Size	Accomplishments
Project A	Jan 15, 2023	Mar 15, 2025	\$500,000	30	Completed all design work ahead of schedule by 2 months
Project B	Jan 15, 2023	Sep 22, 2024	\$225,000	15	Received all components well within budget Narrowed down Suppliers from 20 to 3 Suppliers within 3 weeks
Project C	Jan 15, 2024	Dec 15, 2024	\$100,000	10	Obtained customer acceptance of initial prototype

Creating a Space

To create a new Space, hover your mouse at the "Spaces" menu, and click on the "Create a Space" function.



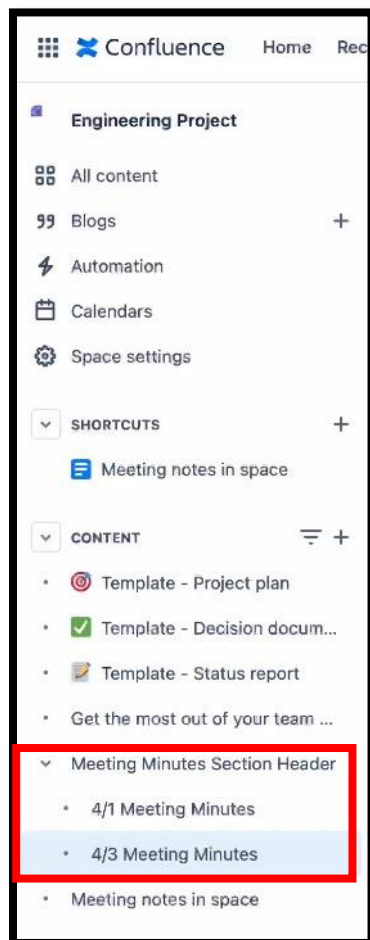
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When you're creating a Space, feel free to select one of Confluence's Templates which best fits your needs:

- Blank = If you're working from scratch
- Team = if your goal is to create an organized place for your team to collaborate
- Documentation = If you're trying to create a hub for storing documentation
- Software Project = To help with managing your software project and keep track of issues and manage the project's roadmap
- Project Management = To help manage all areas of your project, and facilitate team collaborations
- Etc...

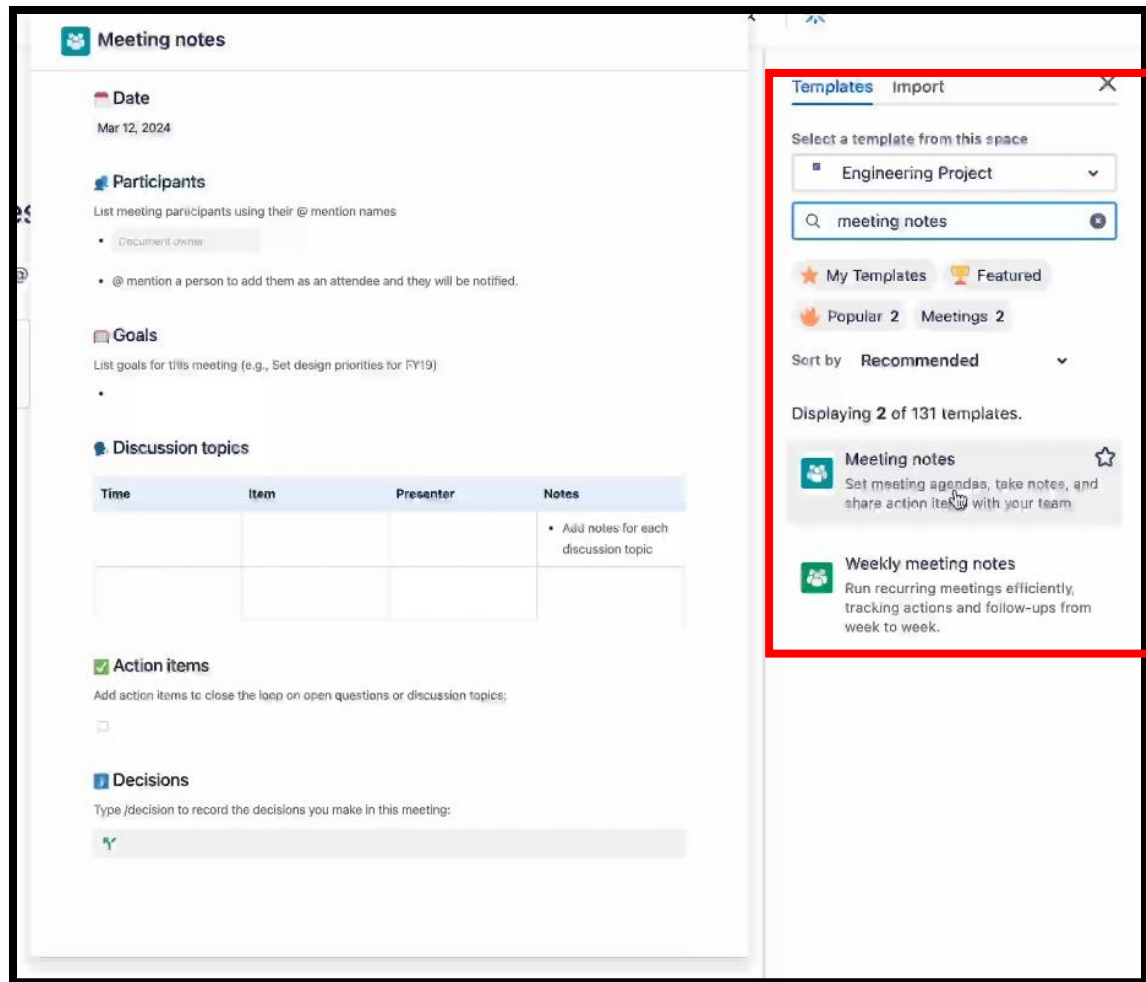
Creating a Meeting Minutes Page

To store all of your Meeting Minutes pages in one location, I recommend creating a Page that's titled "Meeting Minutes Section Header" and all of your Meeting Minutes will reside underneath this Header in the left panel of your screen:



To create your Meeting Minutes Page, I recommend using the pre-built Templates which Confluence has. To do that, in the panel on the right hand screen, search for "meeting notes" and choose the Meeting Minutes Template which best suits your needs.

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In my FREE Course Video, the Template I use is the first Template for '**Meeting notes**'.

Here is an Example of what your final Meeting Minutes will look like when you populate it with information related to your project: (see *next page*)

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4/1 Meeting Minutes



Owned by Alvin, created with a template ...

Less than a minute ago • 1 min read • See how many people viewed this page



Date

Apr 1, 2024



Participants

- Project Manager - @Alvin
- Engineering Team - Elon, Jeff, Bryan
- Procurement Team - Celine, Mariah, Selena



Purpose

- Agree upon the strategy for sourcing prototype designs with our Suppliers



Discussion topics

Item	Notes
Prototype Design	• Prototype design is fully completed, pending feedback from Marketing if other changes have to be made
Testing	• Preliminary testing of prototype is showing successful results
Sourcing	• Suppliers still need to be identified for who will manufacture the design



Action items

- ☐ Brainstorm the five more suppliers to use, @Alvin by Apr 19, 2024
- ☐ Show prototype design to Product Management, @Alvin by May 31, 2024



Decisions



Engineering Team approves the prototype design



Team agrees to proceed with identifying Suppliers to manufacture the prototype



Alvin's Tip: When you're listing out your Action Items...

1. Make sure you use the @ symbol to tag the people assigned to that Action Item.
2. Use the Date Macro to select the data the action item must be completed by.

Using a Rolling Action Items Page

After you create your Meeting Minutes page in your Space, Confluence automatically creates a separate page called “Meeting notes in space”

Description	Due date	Assignee	Task appears on
Brainstorm the five more suppliers to use, @Alvin by 19 Apr 2024	19 Apr 2024	Alvin	4/1 Meeting Minutes
Confirm pricing of manufactured design, @Alvin by 22 Apr 2024	22 Apr 2024	Alvin	4/3 Meeting Minutes
Show prototype design to Product Management, @Alvin by 31 May 2024	31 May 2024	Alvin	4/1 Meeting Minutes

Page Title	Decisions
4/1 Meeting Minutes	Engineering Team approves the prototype design
	Team agrees to proceed with identifying Suppliers to manufacture the prototype

This page will summarize all Incomplete Action Items and Decisions from ALL the Meeting Minutes you create inside of Confluence (as I've shown in the previous section).

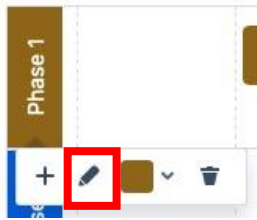
To make sure your tables reflect the most latest data, ALWAYS make sure you go back to Edit mode, and double-click on each table, to verify the data has been refreshed.

Creating a Project Roadmap / Gantt Chart

- Create a new Page and call it “Project Roadmap”. Type the forward slash key “/” and type roadmap, to use the **Roadmap macro**.
- Afterwards, the Roadmap dialogue box shows up. It already comes pre-populated with two swim lanes, and several bars for each swimlane.
- Change your roadmap to reflect what you'd actually see for your project.

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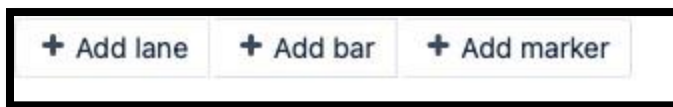
- Modify the Swimlane Title by left-clicking it and then click on the pencil icon to modify the text.



- Left click on a bar, and select the text itself to modify it. For example, rename the Activity so it states **“Gather Requirements”**

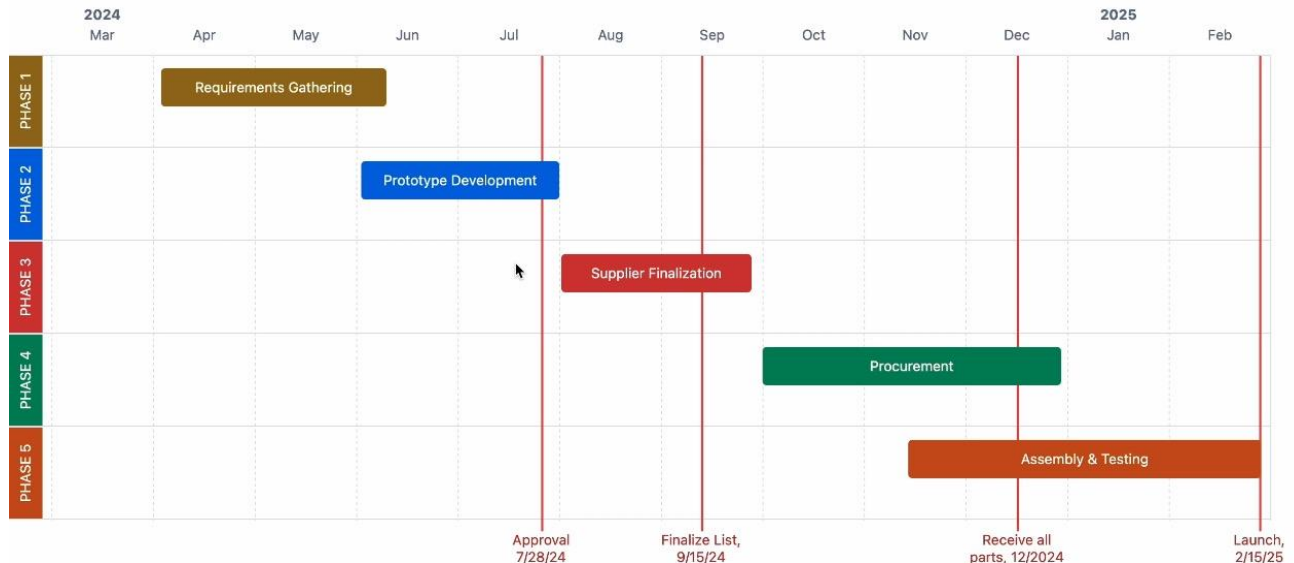


- You can increase or decrease the duration of an Activity, by left-clicking and holding down on the edge of the bar, and moving it to the right or left.
- You can also change where the bar is positioned, by dragging and dropping it onto the appropriate area in the swimlane, below the correct month. For example, moving an Activity to start in June instead of in April.
- To add more swimlanes, more bars, or to add Milestone Markers, click on the appropriate button that shows at the top portion of the Roadmap:



- For Milestone Markers, you can rename it to the correct Title, or position it in the correct timeframe by left-clicking and dragging & dropping to the correct time period (ex: positioning it in the middle of May).

Here's an example of what your Roadmap could look like, with labeled Milestones:



Creating a Project Issue Log

To create an Issue Log, similar to what you've done with creating your Meeting Minutes, you can insert a table using the **table macro**.

Alvin's Tip: Here are recommended columns to use:

Id No	Issue Description	Identified By	Owner	Open Date	Status	Action / Comments
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You can then populate the table with the information of issues your team is experiencing in your project.

Here's an example of what an Issue Log would look like inside Confluence:

Issue Log						
A Owned by Alvin ... Less than a minute ago · 1 min read · See how many people viewed this page						
Id No	Issue Description	Identified By	Owner	Open Date	Status	Action / Comments
1	User Interface does not show correct image	@Alvin	@Alvin	Mar 8, 2024	OPEN	Need to update the image in the interface
2	User Login displays incorrect button	Roger	Roger	Mar 15, 2024	CLOSED	No action needed.
3	Datatable does not correctly add the numbers.	Roger	Roger	Mar 15, 2024	OPEN	Need to investigate with testing team
4	The incorrect sound plays when the user logs into the app.	Roger	Roger	Mar 13, 2024	OPEN	Need to replicate the issue for testing purposes.

Creating a Project Status Report

To create a Project Status Report, you can:

1. Use a pre-built Template which Confluence already has
2. Or, create your own Status Report and build it out yourself

In my FREE Course Video, I use the **table macro** and build out a Status Report with the following column labels: *Last Updated, Sponsor, Project Lead, Phase, Start Date, Planned Finish, Overall Status, Scope, Schedule, Budget, Issues, Strategy to Resolve Issues, Risks, and Major Accomplishments.*

For the rows for: *Overall Status, Scope, Schedule, and Budget*, I use the **Status Macro** to

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specify if the project is **On Track**, **At Risk**, or **Off Track**, and select the appropriate color as a visual indicator.

Here's an example of what your Project Status Report could look like using Confluence:

Project Status Report



Owned by Alvin ...

Just a moment ago • 1 min read • See how many people viewed this page

Last Updated	Mar 15, 2024
Sponsor	@Alvin
Project Lead	@Alvin
Phase	Execution
Start Date	Jan 5, 2024
Planned Finish	Aug 5, 2025
Overall Status	AT RISK
Scope	ON TRACK
Schedule	OFF TRACK
Budget	ON TRACK
Issues	Testing results have failed validation
Strategy to Resolve issues	Redesign the component to mitigate risk of failing the validation
Risks	Three week delay to receiving components.
Major Accomplishments	Engineering team completed all prototyping activities 2 weeks ahead of schedule.

Thank You! 🙏

If you gained value out of my **FREE Confluence Course** ([FOUND HERE](#)), would you do me a favor, and please share my video with a friend and others who you think might find it helpful?

It's my goal to help more than 20,000 people grow and advance their careers in Project Management!

Thank you in advance for helping me reach a bigger audience! Your support means a lot. 😊

Cheers, Alvin